

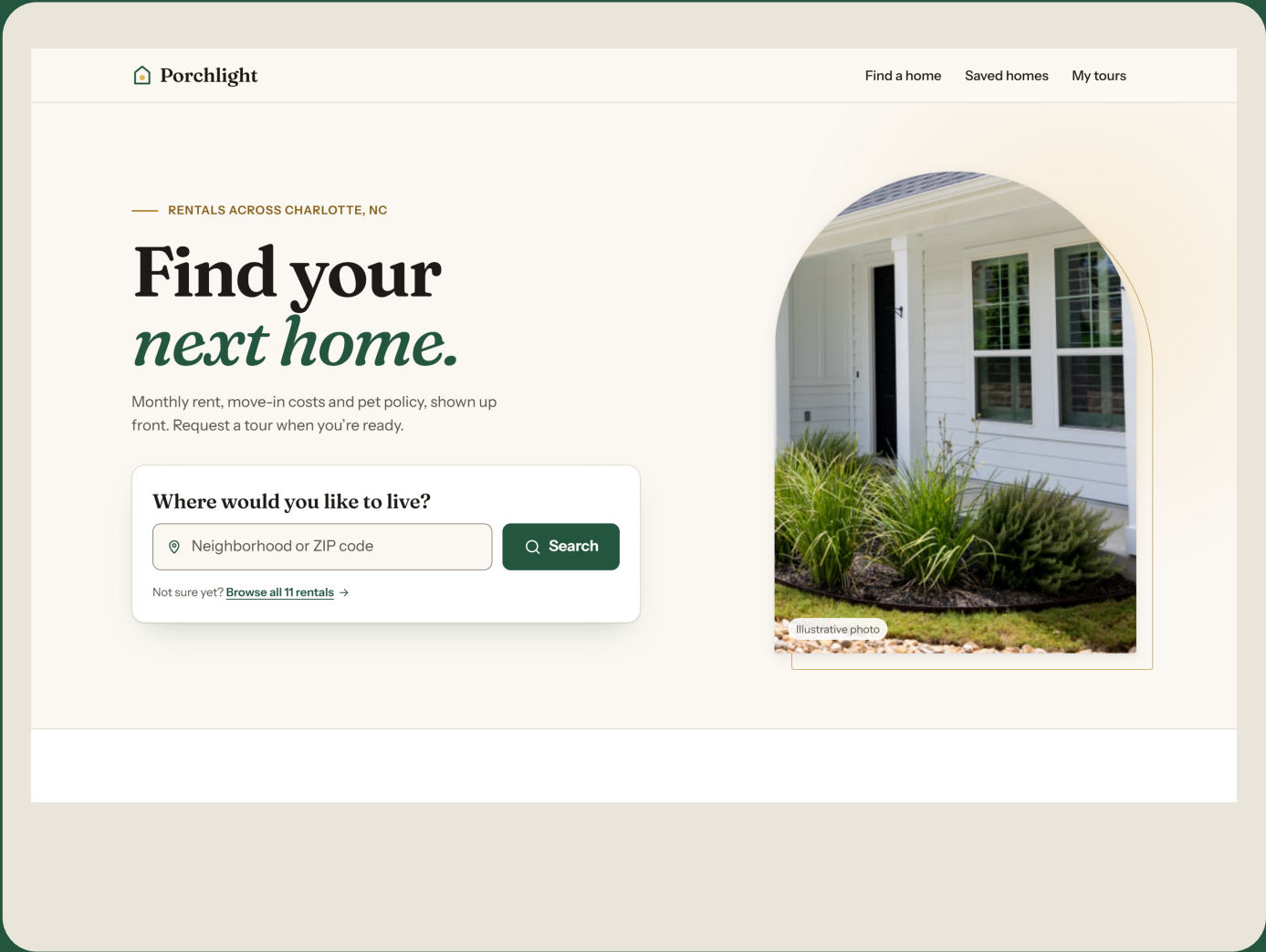
Porchlight

Find a home.
Understand the details.
Know what happens next.

A focused rental experience with clear costs, practical search and a transparent tour-request flow.

ANDREW DUMITRU

Personal concept / Responsive design



Actual Porchlight interface

A rental journey with fewer distractions.

Porchlight brings browsing, property information and tour requests into one focused experience.

The design challenge

Finding a rental involves more than choosing a photograph. A visitor needs to understand the rent, check whether the home fits their needs and know what happens after requesting a visit.

My goal was to make those decisions easier to follow through a consistent interface, useful information hierarchy and clear request status.

AUDIENCE

Prospective renters

An intended audience looking for rentals in Charlotte. This is the design audience, not a recruited research sample.

SCOPE

Search to tour request

Location and preference filters, property details, saved homes, a review step and request management.

Three questions shaped the experience.

I organized the design around what someone needs to decide before taking the next step.

01

Does this home fit?

Put rent, location, bedrooms, availability and pet policy into repeatable listing cards.

02

What will it cost?

Keep base rent explicit, then distinguish one-time fees, refundable deposits and optional monthly charges.

03

What happens next?

Let visitors review their request, see its pending status and change or cancel it afterward.

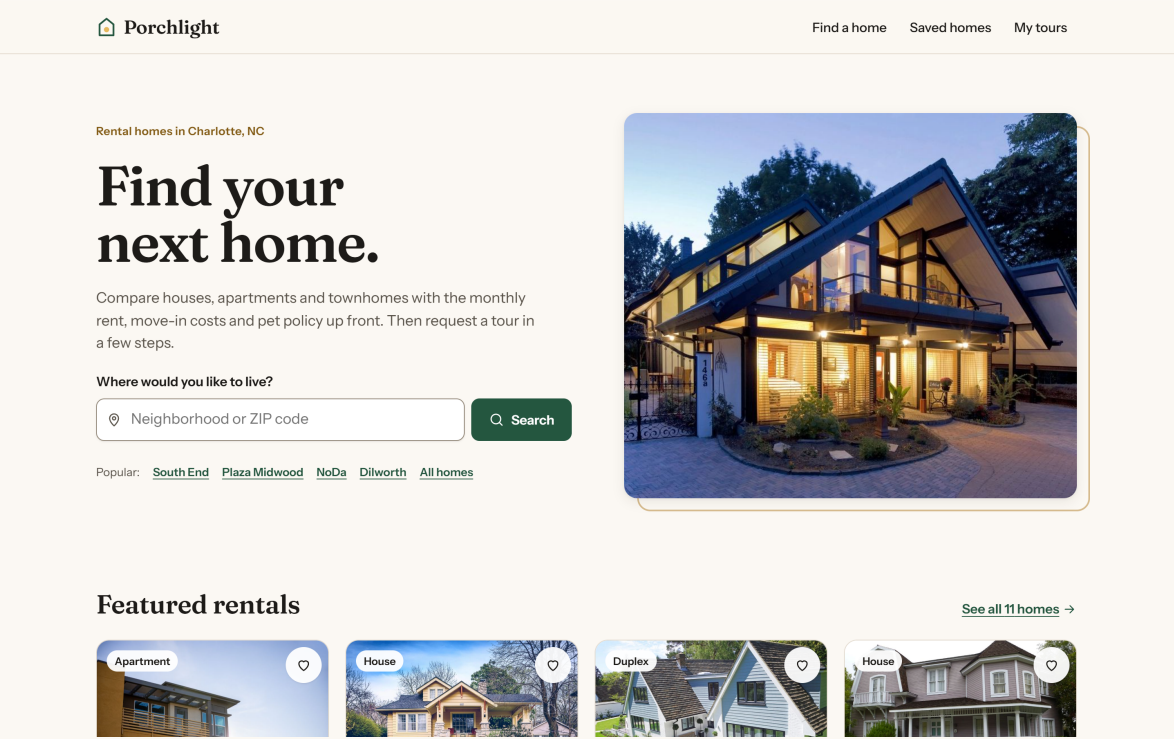
A deliberate scope

I focused on rentals and a list-based search experience. Buying, selling, account creation and a map were outside this version. That gave the main journey a consistent purpose and kept the portfolio prototype manageable.

From a generic hero to a clearer entrance.

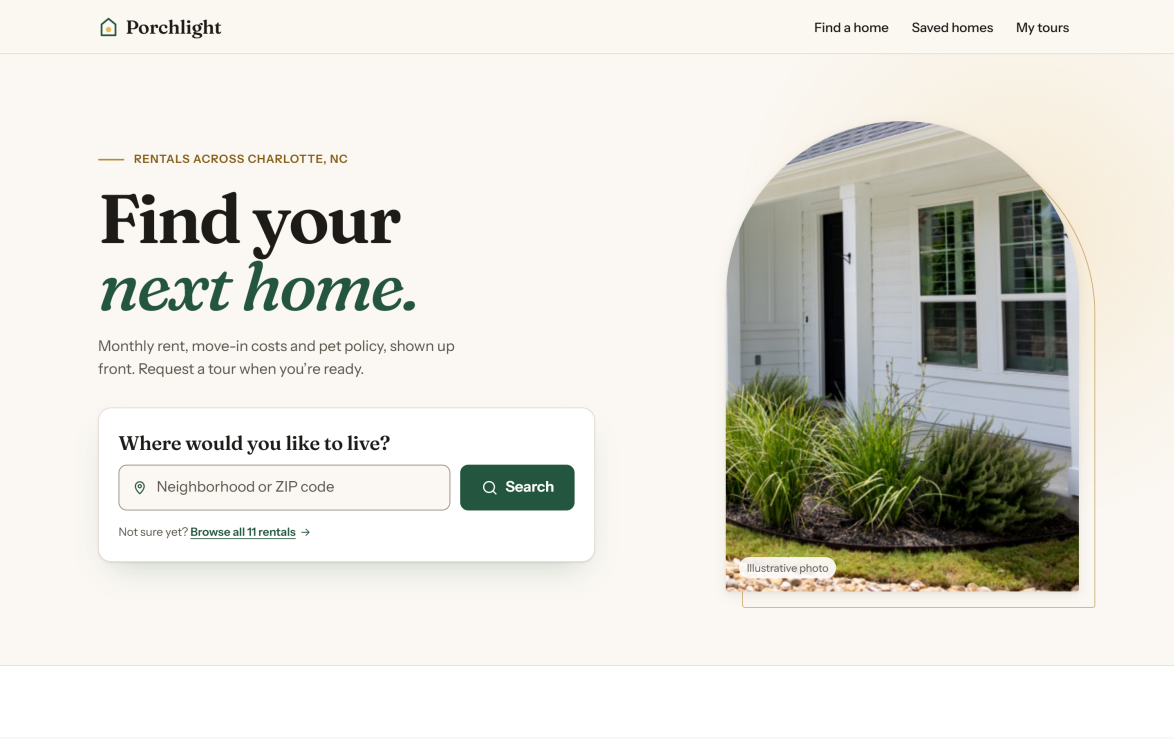
Two documented stages of Porchlight itself show how the homepage direction developed.

EARLIER PORCHLIGHT



Search competed with supporting content. The dramatic house image suggested luxury architecture, and the page lacked a distinctive organizing idea.

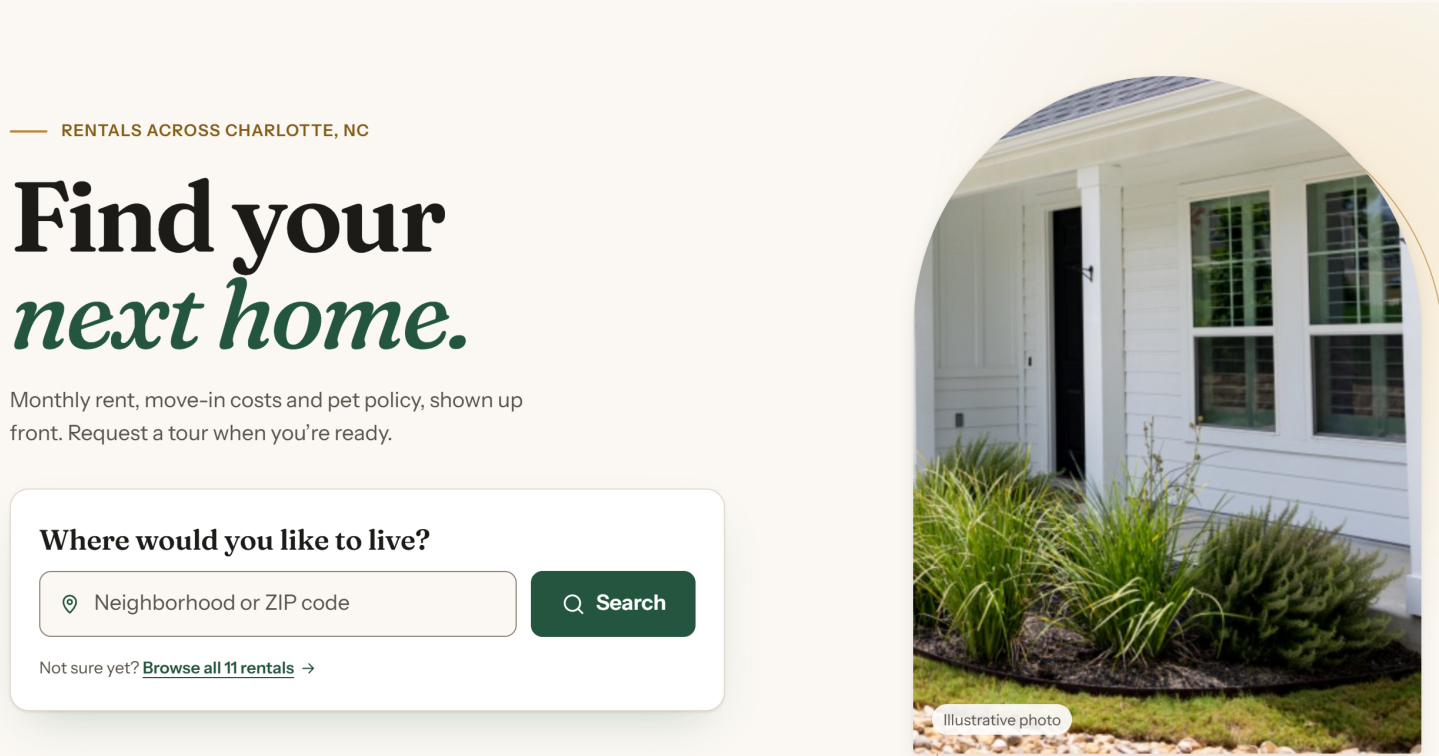
REFINED PORCHLIGHT



A porch image and doorway-shaped frame connect to the name. Search has its own prominent panel, while one browse link provides a quieter alternative.

Warm, residential and easy to scan.

The source files define a consistent palette and type system across the experience.



Fraunces

Display type in the interface: expressive headings, with an italic accent in the homepage headline.

Instrument Sans

Body and interface type: a quieter companion for listing facts, navigation, labels and forms.

Warm white / #FBF8F3

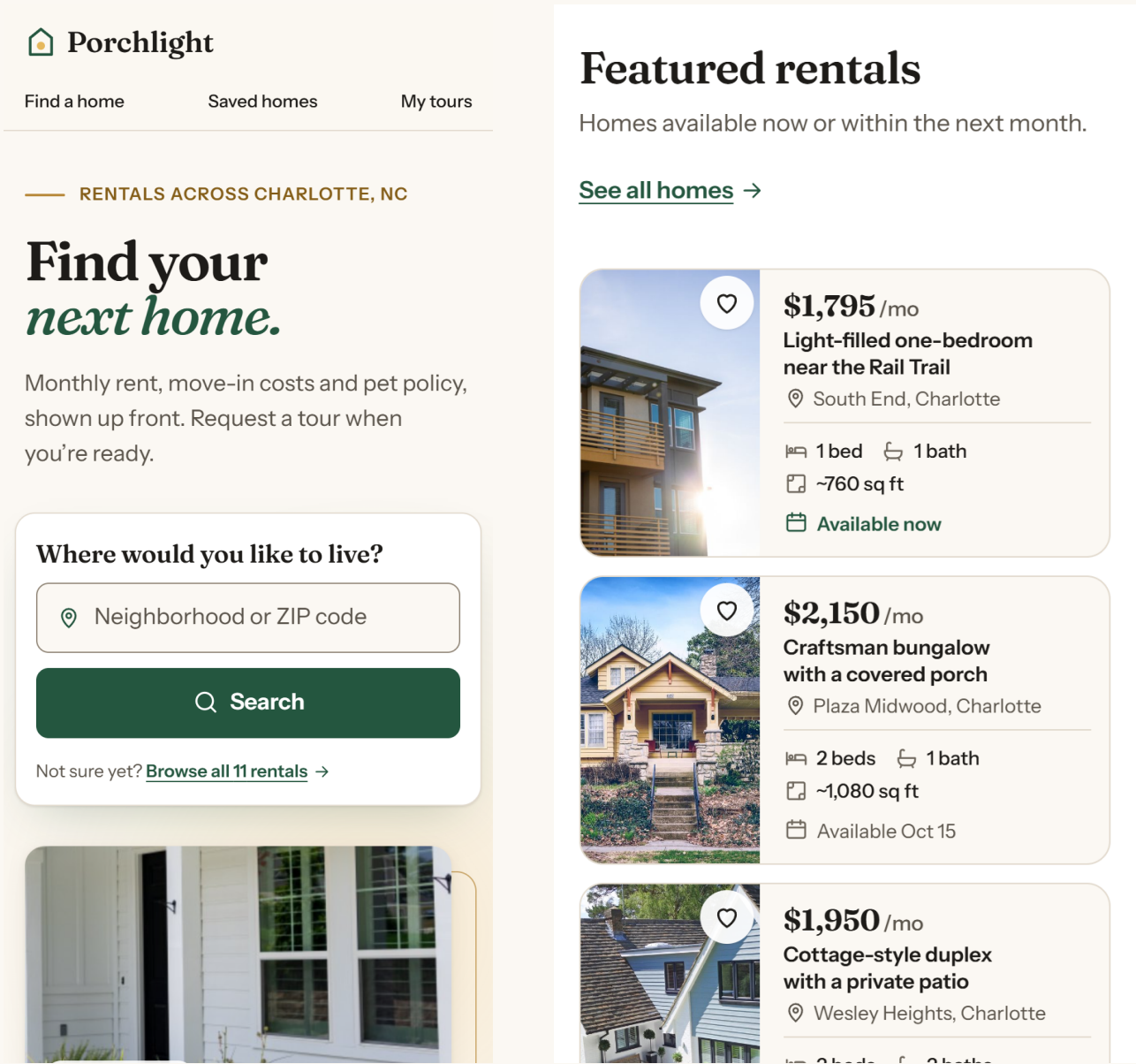
Forest / #24563F

Brass / #B8893A

Text / #1D1B18

A smaller screen needs a different rhythm.

The homepage keeps discovery prominent while reducing repeated content on mobile.



Adapt the composition

The desktop arch becomes a rounded rectangle on mobile. The search field and action stack into a clear entry point before the featured homes.

Make featured homes more compact

Homepage cards switch to rows, with photography beside the key information. The full listing and search screens retain additional details.

Trim secondary choices

Four neighborhood tiles replace eleven repetitive entries. The supporting information becomes a short strip instead of oversized cards.

Help people narrow the field.

Filters and visible selections connect a visitor’s preferences to the homes shown.

[Find a home](#)[Saved homes](#)[My tours](#)

Homes for rent in Charlotte

Neighborhood or ZIP code

Search

Max monthly rent

Bedrooms

Pets

Sort by

\$2,500/mo

Any

Dogs allowed

Rent: low to high

5 homes available

Up to \$2,500/mo

Dogs allowed

Clear all filters

Loft

\$1,650 /mo

Mill-district loft with exposed brick

NoDa, Charlotte

1 bed

1 bath

~840 sq ft

Available Oct 8

Cats and dogs allowed

Apartment

\$1,795 /mo

Light-filled one-bedroom near the Rail Trail

South End, Charlotte

1 bed

1 bath

~760 sq ft

Available now

Cats and dogs allowed

House

\$1,895 /mo

Single-level ranch near the greenway

University City, Charlotte

3 beds

2 baths

~1,420 sq ft

Available Oct 12

Cats and dogs allowed

Duplex

House

Location, rent, bedrooms and pet policy sit together. Active chips explain the current search, and Clear all provides a simple reset. On mobile, filters collapse into a labeled control with an active count.

[Find a home](#)[Saved homes](#)[My tours](#)

Homes for rent in Charlotte

Neighborhood or ZIP code

Search

Sort by

Filters 2

Rent: low to

5 homes available

Up to \$2,500/mo

Dogs allowed

Clear all filters

Loft

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07

Let the home lead. Keep the action close.

Photography establishes the property; structured information supports the decision to request a tour.



Find a home

Saved homes

My tours

← All homes



Photo 1 of 5

View all 5 photos



House • Dilworth

Restored Victorian with a wraparound porch

\$3,250/mo

Monthly rent

A gallery provides multiple views, followed by the title, location and rental facts. On mobile, a persistent action bar keeps monthly rent and Request a tour within reach while the visitor explores the page.



Find a home

Saved homes

My tours

← All homes

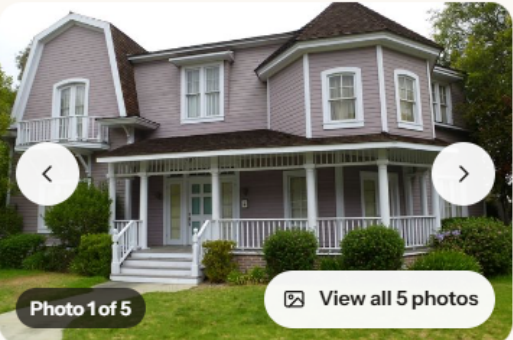


Photo 1 of 5

View all 5 photos



House • Dilworth

Restored Victorian with a wraparound porch

611 Carriage Lamp St, Charlotte, NC 28203

\$3,250

Monthly rent

\$3,250/mo

3 bd • 2 ba

Request a tour

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08

Review the details before sending.

A three-step sequence separates tour selection, contact details and final review.



[Find a home](#)
[Saved homes](#)
[My tours](#)

[← Back to home details](#)

Request a tour


Date and time


Your details


Review

Review your request

Tour

Edit

Property	Restored Victorian with a wraparound porch 611 Carriage Lamp St, Charlotte, NC 28203
Tour type	Virtual tour
Date	Thursday, October 8, 2026
Time	10:00 AM
Time zone	Eastern Time (EDT)

Your details

Edit

Name	Jordan Lee
Email	jordan@example.com
Phone	Not provided


Before you submit

Porchlight is a demo. Submitting won't contact an agent or book a real tour. Your request will be marked "Pending confirmation" and saved in this browser — without your contact details — so you can change or cancel it.

[← Back](#)

Submit tour request



\$3,250/mo

Restored Victorian with a wraparound porch
3 beds · 2 baths
611 Carriage Lamp St, Charlotte, NC 28203



[Find a home](#)
[Saved homes](#)
[My tours](#)
[Photo credits](#)

Rental homes across Charlotte, North Carolina.

Demo experience. Listings are fictional.

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01 Choose the visit

Select an in-person or virtual tour, then a date and available sample time. The time zone is shown explicitly.

02 Provide contact details

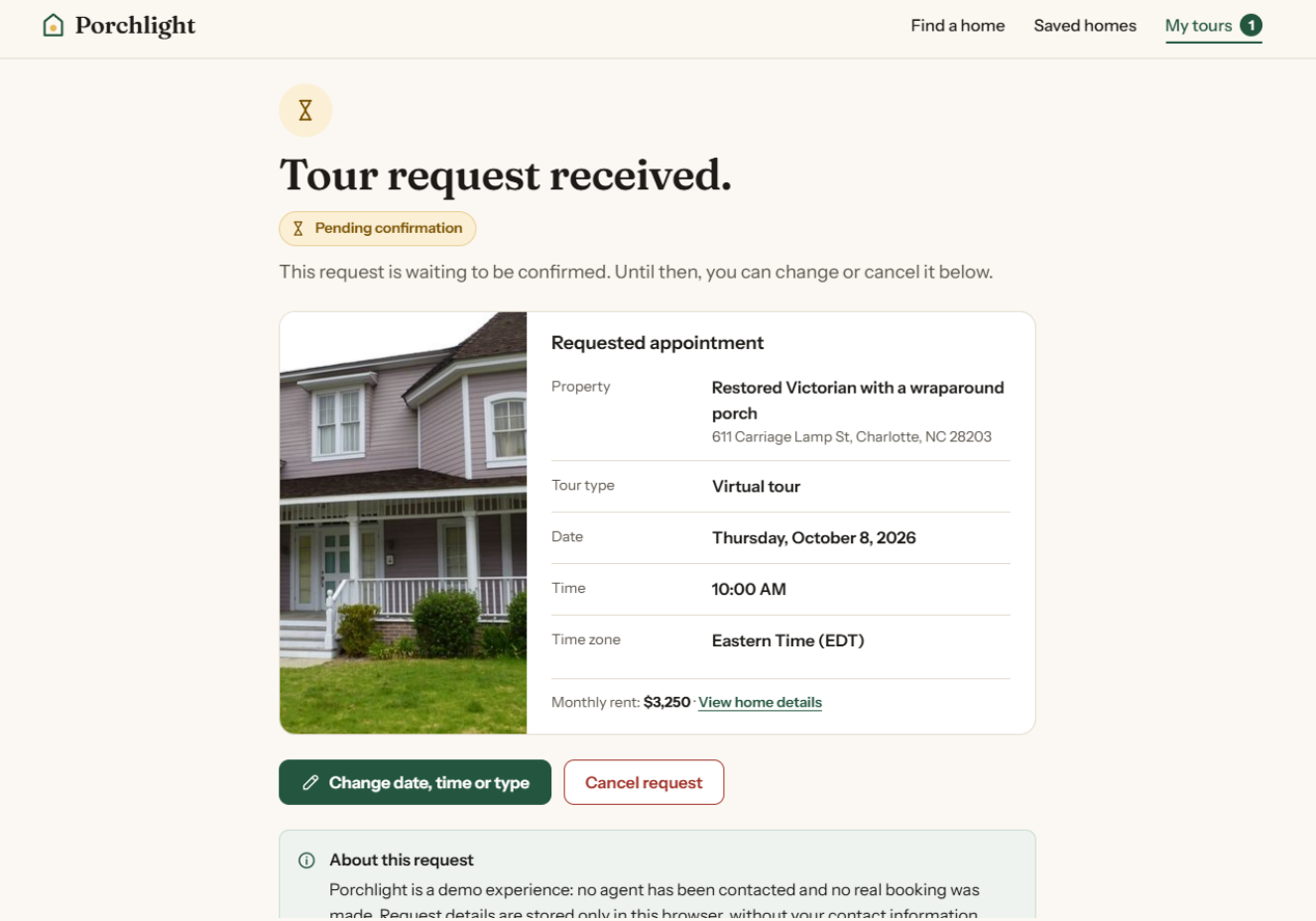
The prototype asks for the information needed to demonstrate the request. Contact fields remain temporary and are not saved with the request.

03 Check and submit

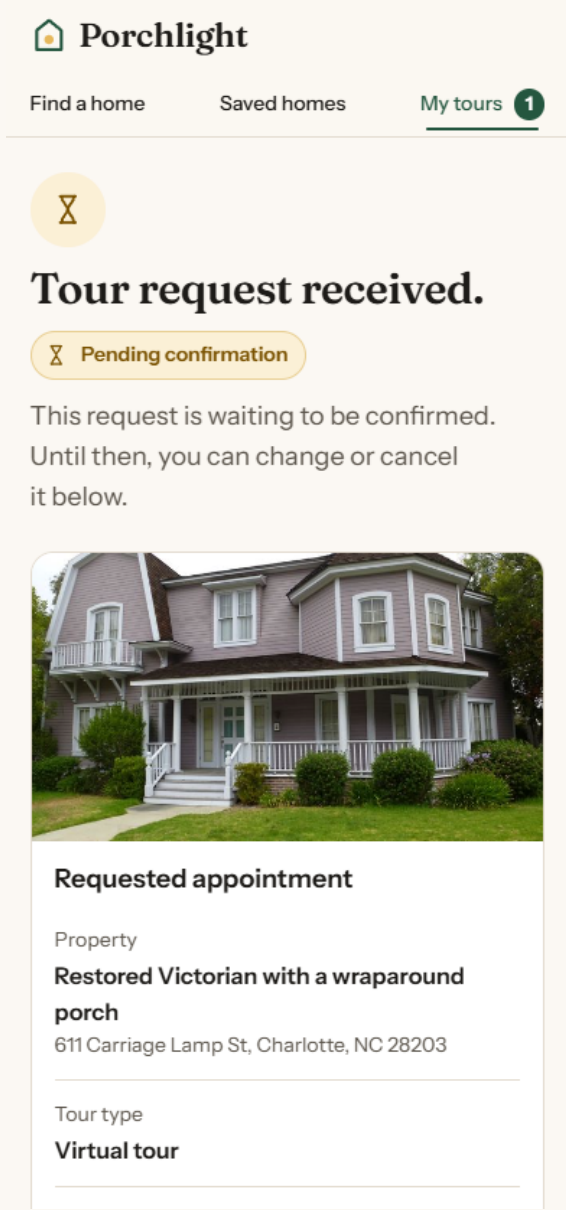
The review screen brings the appointment and contact information together, with edit links and a clear explanation of the demo behavior.

Make the status unambiguous.

Submitting a request and confirming an appointment are different events.

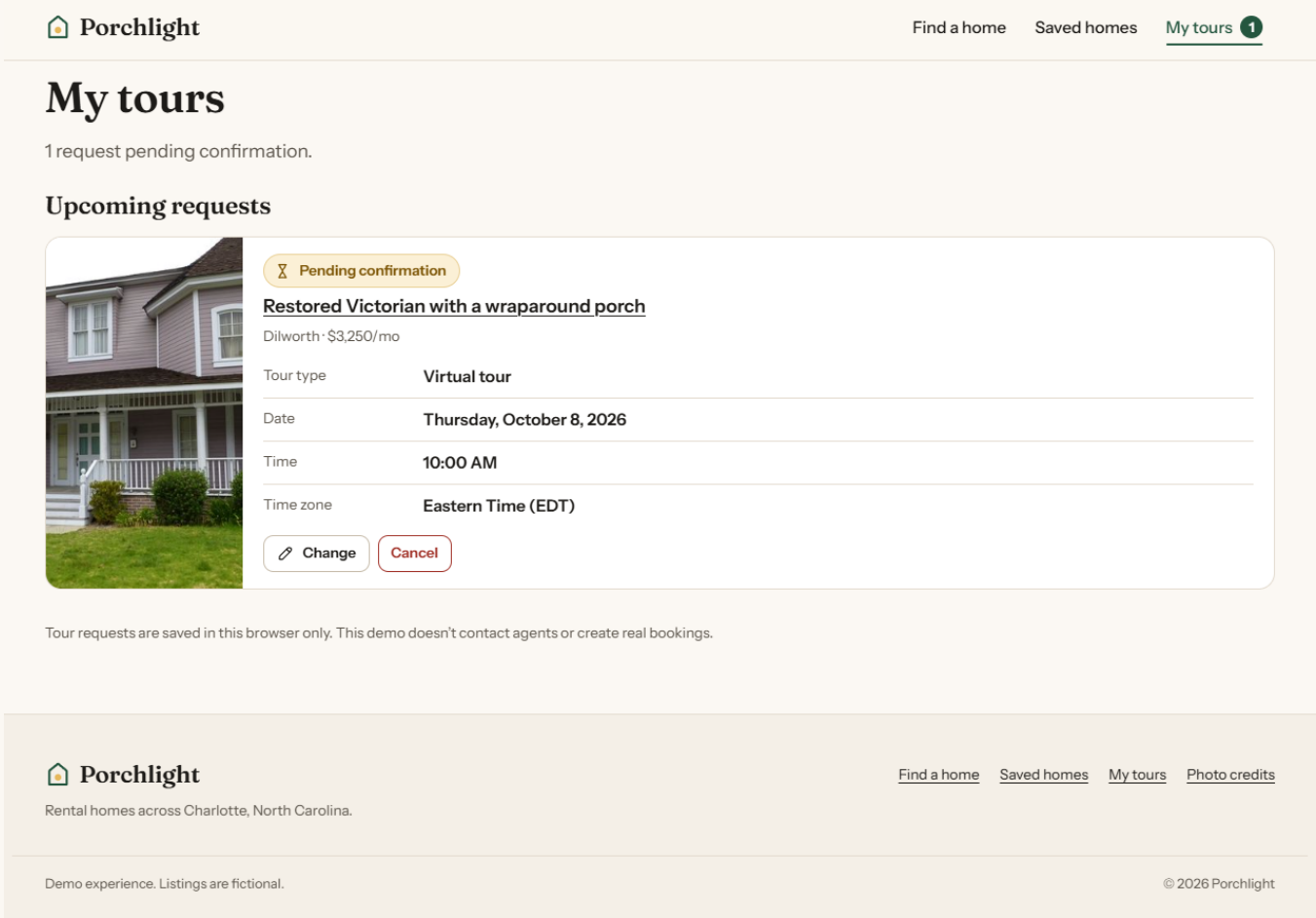


The confirmation says Tour request received and shows Pending confirmation. A property image and appointment summary restore context. Change and cancel actions give the visitor control after submission.



The journey continues after submission.

My tours provides a place to revisit requests. Error states help visitors recover when their selections need attention.



Keep requests findable

My tours repeats the property, requested appointment and status, with change and cancel actions. Visitors can return to the request without repeating the flow.

Explain what needs fixing

The documented review corrected a stale-date failure so an invalid selection returns the visitor to the form with a visible error rather than leaving the page blank.

Other recovery paths

Search has a no-results state and removable filters. Tour forms use error summaries plus field-level messages.

A cohesive prototype, ready for feedback.

The work now shows a complete rental journey and a documented visual refinement.

What I achieved

I established a consistent visual direction, made search more prominent and built a connected path from browsing to request management. Desktop and mobile screens now belong to the same product system.

What I learned

Clarity comes from both presentation and wording. A request status, a fee label and the order of information matter as much as typography and photography. Reducing competing content helped the homepage express its purpose.

What the checks establish

The project log records 38 passing unit tests, a successful build and automated browser checks. It also records accessibility fixes and homepage audits. These are implementation checks, not evidence of improved user success.

What comes next

Test whether prospective renters can find a suitable home, explain its costs and understand a pending tour request. Check mobile use on real devices, then revise the design around observed difficulties.